The Dhāraṇī of the Essence of the Six Perfections

Toh 935 · Derge Kangyur
ཕ་རོལ་ཏུ་ཕྱིན་པ་དགུ་གི་སྙིང་པོའི་གཟུངས།

The Dhāraṇī of the Essence of the Six Perfections, known in Tibetan as Pha rol tu phyin pa drug gi snying po'i gzungs, is a very brief incantation text whose Sanskrit title would correspond to something like a dhāraṇī of the heart or essence of the six perfections. It opens with homage to the noble Mother, the Perfection of Wisdom, and to the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha. It then gives a short spell invoking the three bodies of a buddha, naming in turn the perfections of generosity, discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration, and wisdom, and closing with the emptiness of all phenomena. A brief passage describes its benefits. Whoever retains it is said to retain the six perfections and bring emptiness to mind. Constant recitation is said to bring knowledge of the sūtras and the extensive teachings, to purify even the five acts of immediate retribution, and to protect against harm from bad omens. It is Toh 935 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī texts, the collection of short incantations and protective formulas.

The Dhāraṇī of the Essence of the Six Perfections

Homage to the noble Mother, the Perfection of Wisdom.
Homage to the Buddha.
Homage to the Dharma.
Homage to the Saṅgha.

namo dharmakāya saṃbhogakāya nirmāṇakāya tadyathā dānapāramitā śīlapāramitā kṣāntipāramitā bīryapāramitā dhyanabāramitā prajñāpāramitā sarbadharmaśūnyatā svāhā

By retaining this, one will retain the six perfections. One will have brought emptiness to mind. If one recites it constantly, one will come to know the sūtras and the extensive teachings of all the Dharma. The five acts of immediate retribution will be purified. Not even any bad omen will bring harm.

The Dhāraṇī of the Essence of the Six Perfections is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The phrase rendered "the sūtras and the extensive teachings" (mdo dang rgyas pa) most likely refers to the sūtra and vaipulya classes of scripture among the traditional divisions of the

Buddha's word. The "five acts of immediate retribution" (ānantarya) are killing one's father, killing one's mother, killing an arhat, drawing a buddha's blood with malicious intent, and causing a schism in the Saṅgha.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.